

an “Independent Gaming Chip,” which acts as a secondary chip that supports the SD 8+ Gen 1 to offer a more seamless and smooth gaming experience, without putting much stress on the main chip.

The Independent Gaming Chip (IGC), is basically a hardware solution for frame rate interpolation, where the smartphone forces extra frames in games to be able to offer the highest possible FPS for a longer period of time. While there is no way to test this IGC independently, the gaming experience on the smartphone felt super smooth. I played games like Call of Duty: Mobile and Battleground Mobile India on the iQOO Neo 7 Pro, and the experience was nothing less than absolutely slick.

During my gaming sessions, the iQOO Neo 7 Pro 5G kept the frame rates constant and the gameplay was absolutely smooth even on the highest graphics and frame rate settings. It did heat up a bit during long gaming sessions, but never was it “too hot to handle.” One thing I’d like to mention again here is that the weight of the smartphone made the gaming experience more than comfortable and I was able to hold on to the smartphone for long hours without things getting uncomfortable.

Coming to benchmarks, the iQOO Neo 7 Pro 5G, as expected, left the competition in the dust with some of the highest numbers we have ever seen on any mid-range smartphone. The iQOO Neo 7 Pro 5G easily sets a new performance benchmark in this segment, coming above some of the most powerful smartphones in this range. Devices like the OnePlus Nord 3 5G and Poco F5, which were some of the top performing devices in this range now don’t seem as astonishing after the iQOO Neo 7 Pro’s numbers.

On AnTuTu, the smartphone gave an impressive score of about 1.23 million, which is not only the highest in the mid-range segment, the iQOO Neo 7 Pro 5G also beats some flagships like the Samsung Galaxy S23 series, the Vivo X90 Pro, and even the iQOO 11, which is iQOO’s flagship for this year itself. This just proves how good of a performer the

iQOO Neo 7 Pro 5G is. On Geekbench, the iQOO Neo 7 Pro 5G scored 1723 points in the single-core test and 4430 points in the multi-core test, which is again one of the highest in its segment and even above a few flagships of this year. Impressive. On PCMark Work 3.0, the iQOO Neo 7 Pro 5G’s performance wasn’t up to the mark. The smartphone scored 11485 points, which is very good, but not the highest we have seen in the mid-range.

In GPU-based benchmarks also, the iQOO Neo 7 Pro 5G leaves the competition in the dust. In fact, the smartphone punches above its weight here as well, with a 3D Mark Wildlife Extreme score of 2661 points, and the highest GFX Bench scores in the tests we ran on the iQOO Neo 7 Pro 5G.

So the performance of the iQOO Neo 7 Pro 5G is the best we have seen on a mid-range smartphone in a long time. It not only beats its competition by a margin, but takes the fight to the flagships of today with a solid performance across benchmarks and GPU tests. Brilliant stuff.

The battery on the iQOO Neo 7 Pro is also good. We get a 5,000mAh battery, which also seems optimised for gaming. For example, the iQOO Neo 7 Pro 5G did not drain much battery while gaming or watching content, but the smartphone drained a significant amount while using GPS. In one hour of GPS navigation, the smartphone drained about 9 percent of the battery, but a 15-minute gaming session only drained 3 percent of the battery, which is very good for a smartphone.

The charging, however, makes up for any minor rough edges with the battery optimisation. The iQOO Neo 7 5G comes with 120W fast charging. I tested this from 0-100, and the smartphone only took 29 minutes to charge fully. Beautifully fast.

CAMERA

The camera on the iQOO Neo 7 5G is also decent. The smartphone comes with a triple rear camera setup, which has a primary 50-megapixel shooter, an 8-megapixel ultra-wide angle lens, and a 2-megapixel macro lens. The images

from the primary shooter are very good. The smartphone clicks sharp and detailed images, just the colours are a bit washed out.

The portraits from the smartphone are also very good, just at times I found the edge detection to be a bit inaccurate, and here also the colours seem a bit washed out. In low light shots also, the iQOO Neo 7 Pro performs well. Here also, the images remain sharp and detailed, and the colour retention is also okay, but not the best out there.

What I didn’t like about this camera is the ultra-wide shooter. The images in ultra-wide look slightly more soft as compared to the sharp images out of the primary shooter. The colours here are also a bit too saturated for my taste, which further makes it seem like the photos aren’t accurate.

VERDICT

So after testing the iQOO Neo 7 Pro 5G for about two weeks and using the smartphone, I can confidently say that this is probably the best price-to-performance ratio you can get in the market right now. For a ₹ 34,999 price tag, this smartphone takes the fight to devices that are twice its price or even more! So in terms of performance, the numbers speak for themselves.

Apart from this, we get a familiar design with a premium touch, a very colour accurate display, and on top of that, a pretty decent camera which will do very well if your usage is casual and mostly for social media. The battery is also optimised towards performance, and the 120W fast charging is as fast as it gets on a smartphone in this range.

—Darab Mansoor Ali

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Snapdragon® 8+ Gen 1 Mobile Platform | Storage: 128 GB | RAM: 8 GB | Display size: 17.22cm (6.78-inch) | Display resolution: 1080 x 2400 pixels (FHD+) | Cameras (rear): 50 MP OIS camera + 8 MP wide + 2 MP macro | Selfie camera: 16 MP | Battery capacity: 5,000 mAh | Charging: 120 W wired

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